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FOSTERING PLURALISM

Axis Bank, with its initiatives and policies, is striving to make a holistic difference to people's careers and hone their skills too

BY TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL

AXIS BANK, THE country's third-largest private sector bank in terms of total assets, has been making significant strides not just in financial services but also in creating an inclusive and employee-friendly work environment. One of its key landmarks has been the strategic and well-executed acquisition of Citi's consumer banking business in India. The ₹11,603-crore buy that Axis Bank completed on March 1, 2023, meant the integration of Citi's India team of 3,200 people with the lender, and dealing with the cultural differences that typically exist between a domestic entity and a foreign one.

"The integration has progressed extremely well, and we have seen Citi employees continue to build their careers with Axis. We have seen them take

10 AXIS BANK TOP ATTRIBUTES

- FAIR AND OBJECTIVE PROCESSES AND POLICIES
- GROWTH AND LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES
- ENABLES EXPRESSION OF OPINIONS

◀ **LEADING BY EXAMPLE** Rajkamal Vempati, President & Head-Human Resources, Axis Bank

on ambitious roles within both the integrated businesses, and in some cases, senior leaders have moved into large portfolios within the Axis system. In all our talent and engagement programmes, we see good representation from the Citi team," says Rajkamal Vempati, President & Head-Human Resources at Axis Bank. In 2023-24, Axis Bank saw its net profit surge to ₹24,861 crore from ₹9,580 crore in FY23, a remarkable 160% increase. Meanwhile, its net interest income grew 16% to ₹49,894 crore from ₹42,946 crore in 2022-23.

In line with evolving global work trends, Axis Bank was the first in the banking sector to announce a transition to a hybrid working model in 2020 with a two-day roster for non-branch employees at large offices. "We took a call early in April 2020 that our organisation wouldn't return to the full-time, in-office model that we were in before the pandemic. We have since then only reinforced our commitment to flexible work. We have launched GIG-A-Opportunities offering full-time virtual and freelancer roles to broaden our access to talent wherever it may be," adds Vempati.

Coupled with the GIG-A initiative, Axis Bank also launched project 'Thrive' for its employees. "We are the first in the banking system